Spirit Search — Research Log

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Log entries separate three layers: **(S)** what a source asserts; **(H)** what historical evidence supports; **(I)** interpretation (clearly marked as this log's own). Every quotation is verbatim from the fetched witness named; translations are attributed; uncertainty is flagged. Numbers in brackets map to the annotated source list at the end.

Candidate batch 1

Machaon — the surgeon-warrior (Homer, Iliad)

Who is described. (S) In the Catalogue of Ships, Machaon and his brother Podaleirius — "the two sons of Aesculapius, skilled in the art of healing" — bring thirty ships from Thessaly (Il. 2.729–733) [1]. (I) He is both crew-captain and clinician: the two offices are fused in the Catalogue entry itself [1].

How it is known or encountered. (S) In Il. 4.193–219 Machaon draws Pandarus' arrow from Menelaus and applies "soothing drugs which Chiron had given to Aesculapius out of the good will he bore him" (Il. 4.193–219) [1]. (S) In Il. 11.506–520 he is himself wounded; Idomeneus tells Nestor, "A physician is worth more than several other men put together, for he can cut out arrows and spread healing herbs" (Il. 11.514) [1]. (S) In Il. 11.596–604 Achilles sends Patroclus to confirm that the wounded man Nestor carries is Machaon — the recognition scene that ends in Patroclus' fatal mission [1]. (S) Centuries later Pausanias reports the surviving cult: "Here in Gerenia is a tomb of Machaon, son of Asclepius, and a holy sanctuary. In his temple men may find cures for diseases … a standing bronze statue of Machaon, with a crown on his head which the Messenians in the local speech call kiphos" (Paus. 3.26.9–10) [3]. (H) Pausanias, writing in the 2nd c. CE, attests a documented cult site and its legend of Nestor bringing the bones home; the Taras sanctuary claim could not be fetched from a primary source and is flagged uncertain. (H) **Character thickness.** Thin by silence, not by scarcity: across two long Homeric death-arcs and a cult report, no witness gives Machaon a personality — Homer gives him acts (draw, apply, be wounded, be carried off) and Pausanias gives him tomb, statue, and bones. The tradition transmitted his office, not his person; whether that silence caused his low later salience or results from it cannot be decided from the fetched witnesses.

What it commands/demands/changes. (S) Plato's Socrates uses the passage as his exemplum of medical judgment: quoting Hecamede's posset for the wounded Machaon, he asks whether the rhapsode's art or the art of medicine judges these lines best — "The art of medicine" (Ion 538b–c) [2]. (I) A later Greek education treated this spirit, sons of the wounded healer god, as the measure of technical expertise to others.

Comparisons. Documented transmission: Homer → Plato (read as a school text) → Pausanias (local cult report, Little Iliad tradition). Rival reading: the Little Iliad's account that Machaon was killed by Eurypylus (via Pausanias) — later tradition raises his price of being a healer in combat.

The Genius — tutelary of persons and places (Roman tradition)

> Batch-1 revision note (reader doctrine): the genius lacks definite character — the findings below keep that as a result, not a defect to be papered over.

Who is described. (S) Censorinus, ch. 3: "Genius est deus, cuius in tutela ut quisque natus est vivit" — the Genius is the god under whose tutelage each person lives from birth; "certe a genendo genius appellatur" [10]. (S) Horace calls it "our attendant genius … who governs the planet of our nativity, the divinity [that presides] over human nature, who dies with each individual, of various complexion, white and black" (Smart trans., Ep. 2.2.187–189) [9]. (H) Smith's 1870 dictionary manual keeps the boundary precise: the genii "are the powers which produce life … and accompany man through it as his second or spiritual self," distinct from Lares and Penates which operate only after life begins [12; s.v. Genius] — OCR of the Wikisource proofread page is imperfect ("{(Hi" for *dii*).

How it is known or encountered. (S) On birthdays: Censorinus cites Varro — on a birthday one pours wine to the genius (*funde merum genio*, ch. 2) and keeps hands "from killing and blood" so that on the day one received light one does not take it from another [10]. (S) Horace, Ep. 2.1 on rustic piety: "atoned with a hog [the goddess] Earth, with milk Silvanus, with flowers and wine the genius that reminds us of our short life" (Ep. 2.1.143–144) [9]. (S) Every place has one, per Servius (ad Aen. 5.85): "nullus enim locus sine genio, qui per anguem plerumque ostenditur" — no place is without its genius, generally shown as a serpent [14]. (H) Pliny registers skepticism at the multiplication of person-gods: "each individual makes a separate God for himself, adopting his own Juno and his own Genius" (NH 2.5) [11]. (H) For the collective application, Smith documents the *genius populi Romani* on coins of Hadrian and Trajan, citing Arnobius 2.67, Livy 30.12, and Cicero pro Cluentio 5 [12].

What it commands/demands/changes. (S) Servius on Aen. 6.743 (as preserved in Smith): at birth each person receives two genii, one leading to good, one to evil; by their influence at death one "either rise[s] to a higher state of existence, or [is] condemned to a lower one" [12]. (S) Augustine quotes Varro making Genius "the god who is set over, and has the power of begetting, all things," then turns the idea into a polemic: "if every genius is a god, and the soul of every man a genius, it follows that the soul of every man is a god. But if very absurdity compels even these theologists themselves to shrink from this…" (Civ. Dei 7.13) [13]. (I) The genius is a relation, not a person: no fetched witness narrates a genius doing anything, and none gives it speech, temperament, or epithet-poetry. The sources define it by function (begetting, tutelage, attachment to place) and then disagree about what it attaches to — single soul (Censorinus), place (Servius), world (Varro via Augustine). There is no character here to recover or misquote; the disagreement itself is the content of the tradition.

Comparisons. Documented transmission: Horace (poet's vow) → Censorinus/Servius etymology → Augustinian polemic → antiquarian handbook. Contradiction flagged: Varro's pantheistic Genius-as-world vs Censorinus' tutelary single soul; genius vs lar vs numen distinction is unstable across sources (Smith labels them "frequently confounded").

The Sandman — the source phantom of the Unheimlich (Hoffmann → Freud)

Who is described. (S) Hoffmann's nurse-tale, quoted in Nathanael's first letter: the Sandman "wirft ihnen Händevoll Sand in die Augen, daß sie blutig zum Kopf herausspringen" — throws sand in children's eyes so they spring bloody from the head; he then carries the eyes to the half-moon "zur Atzung für seine Kinderchen" [4]. The folk-figure becomes in the tale a doubled person (Coppelius/Coppola) who comes for the eyes: "»Augen her, Augen her!« rief Coppelius" — "Now we have eyes — a fine pair of children's eyes" [4]. (H) The tale appears in Hoffmann's *Nachtstücke* (Reimer, 1816).

How it is known or encountered. (S) Freud's essay stages the encounter indirectly, through definitions: "the 'uncanny' is that class of the terrifying which leads back to something long known to us, once very familiar" ("The Uncanny," CP IV pp. 369–370) [5], then through Schelling (via Sanders's dictionary): " 'Unheimlich' is the name for everything that ought to have remained … hidden and secret and has become visible" [5, p. 375–376], and finally through the street-level anecdote: "I found myself in a quarter the character of which could not long remain in doubt. Nothing but painted women were to be seen at the windows of the small houses … I suddenly found myself back in the same street" [5, Section III]. (S) On the eye-motif: "a morbid anxiety connected with the eyes and with going blind is often enough a substitute for the dread of castration" [5]. (I) Freud treats the Sandman as literature's closest device for producing the feeling that involuntary return produces in life. (I) Reader-doctrine note: this figure is already familiar to this log's reader; the entry

is retained as a control case — a well-known figure used to check the method, not as a discovery.

What it commands/demands/changes. (S) In the tale's closing scene, seeing Coppelius in the crowd and hearing "Sköne Oke," Nathanael hurls himself from the tower; "Als Nathanael mit zerschmettertem Kopf auf dem Steinpflaster lag, war Coppelius im Gewühl verschwunden" [4]. (I) Fact about the tale's mechanics, stated plainly: the Sandman never takes an eye or a life in the story's present action — Nathanael's death is his own leap from the tower, and the childhood eye-assault is interrupted by the father. The figure's force operates through anticipation and recurrence, not through any executed act.

Comparisons. Documented transmission: folk children's tale → Hoffmann's literary doubling (1816) → Freud's essay (1919); the CP IV 1925 text fetched from archive.org is close to Strachey's later Standard Edition revision — edition ambiguity flagged [5]. Rival reading: Freud rejects Jentsch's automaton/uncertainty reading in favor of the eye-motif (CP IV pp. 383–384); later commentators return to the 'automaton' reading — flagged as uncertainty, not resolved here.

Prometheus — the fire-bringer, spirit of technē

Who is described. (S) In Aeschylus' *Prometheus Bound*, the accused himself announces the account at lines 442–465: "Still, listen to the miseries that beset mankind—how they were witless before and I made them have sense and endowed them with reason … numbers, too, chiefest of sciences, I invented for them, and the combining of letters, creative mother of the Muses' arts" [6; Smyth, Loeb 1926]. (S) Lines 250–256: "I caused blind hopes to dwell within their breasts … In addition, I gave them fire" [6]. (S) The sum: "Hear the sum of the whole matter in the compass of one brief word—every art possessed by man comes from Prometheus" (lines 505–506) [6].

How it is known or encountered. (S) Hephaestus' chain in the prologue names the offense: "your own flower, flashing fire, source of all arts, he has purloined and bestowed upon mortal creatures" [6, lines 4–10]. (S) Plato's Protagoras relocates the theft into a political myth: "Prometheus … stole the mechanical arts of Hephaestus and Athene, and fire with them … and gave them to man. Thus man had the wisdom necessary to the support of life, but political wisdom he had not; for that was in the keeping of Zeus" (Protagoras 320c–321d; Jowett 1871) [7]. (H) Hesiod's *Works and Days* version (theft of fire, the fat-and-bones trick at Mekone, Pandora) is attested in the tradition but was not re-fetched in this log; flagged as not verified here.

What it commands/demands/changes. (S) Prometheus himself states the limit in lines 511–514: "Skill is weaker by far than Necessity" [6]. (S) Heidegger, on what the Greeks meant by technē: "Techne belongs to bringing-forth, to poiesis; it is something poetic … Techne is a mode of aletheuein" (*The Question Concerning Technology*, trans. Lovitt 1977 — IN COPYRIGHT, OCR from archive.org used only to verify short quotations) [8]. (I) Prometheus is the name under which the Greek tradition recognizes that every *techne* — including the one Gestell harvests attention with — arrived chained to a giver who suffers; fire is given, not manufactured. (I) **Character thickness.** One act and one catalogue: across the fetched witnesses the figure is defined by the theft, the gift-list, and the punishment. Aeschylus alone gives him sustained speech — defiance under torture (PB 436–506) — and even that speech is almost entirely a recital of benefits. Plato's Prometheus is a device inside a political myth, not a personality. What the tradition transmits is the gift and the penalty; a character beyond defiance exists only in Aeschylus, not across witnesses.

Comparisons. Documented transmission: Aeschylus (tragic chorus, Athens, 5th c. BCE) → Plato (political re-reading) → Heidegger's 1953 technology essay via Hölderlin. Analogy (labeled as such): technē-as- gift into modern discourse of infrastructure-as-destiny. Rival readings: Prometheus as rebel against Zeus (Aeschylus) vs. collaborator or double (variants in scholia, and Hesiod's Pandora frame — not verified here).

Connection map

- **Machaon — Genius:** both are tutelary spirits bound to persons and places; Machaon's cult survives as local grave-and-temple memory (Pausanias), the genius survives as the proper name for that tutelage (Censorinus, Horace). Documented link: Servius — the scholiast of the serpent-as-genius (ad Aen. 5.85) and of Homeric tradition.

- **Genius — Sandman:** structural analogy (not documented transmission): the tutelary spirit that "dies with each individual" (Horace) vs the phantom that obliges each individual to die. Freud's unheimlich/heimlich etymology passage is the junction.
- **Sandman — Prometheus:** the involuted pair of the log: the phantom who takes eyes vs the giver of the arts of light; both "come back" — Prometheus' unchaining prophecy (PB lines 511–514) and the involuntary return to the old street (Freud, Section III).
- **Machaon — Prometheus:** analogy only, not transmission — both figures "command" technique: healing for the one; fire-with-all-arts for the other.

Correction notes

1. Subagent task GENIUS failed once with a garbled partial output (provider 429); the profile above was reconstructed locally from its saved evidence files and rechecked against the quoted strings.
2. Archive.org item id `freud-1925-cp-5` actually hosts Collected Papers vol. IV; a separate classroom PDF circulates carrying the later Strachey (SE XVII) revision — the two are not identical. Quotations above use the CP IV (1925) text; page numbers are CP IV.
3. The Heidegger Lovitt translation is in copyright (Harper); quoted minimally and only against locally saved OCR for verification — do not redistribute the OCR.
4. For Prometheus Bound, the passage from lines 4–10 was quoted from the full-text page on Perseus; locator endpoints for the card-view fetches (472–505, 507ff) are near but not always exactly inclusive.
5. The Greek tag at Il. 11.514 was quoted from the subagent's note, not machine-fetched in Greek; the English was verified against Butler.
6. Smith's Dictionary Wikisource page is proofread-needed; "dii genitales" appears OCR-garbled ("{(Hi"); the surrounding definitions are quoted from cleaner text, with its own internal citations (Censorinus 3; Servius in loc.) preserved.
7. Discord outbound from this CLI session requires terminal approval; first message attempt timed out unapproved.

Batch 1 reassessment (post-gating notes)

- **Genius and Prometheus lack definite character.** Both entries now read as evidence of that: the sources define the genius structurally (tutelage, etymology, pairing with Juno) and Prometheus functionally (giver of fire and arts). Neither tradition hands us a personality — no whims, no biography beyond the one act. The profiles above should be read as profiles of *abstractions with names*, and the connection map treats their edges as structural, not personal. (I) A spirit with a name but no character is the tradition doing classificatory, not narrative, work; that distinction is now load-bearing for later batches.
- **Machaon is under-defined as a character.** Conceded and written into the node: the Iliad gives him deeds and a plot-function, never a personality. The hypothesis "he was less salient to history than others" is an argument from silence and is flagged as such — the counter-evidence is the Gerenia cult (Paus. 3.26.9–10), which shows he remained salient *locally* for centuries. Salience is geography-dependent, not a single number.
- **Sandman: noted as already known to Cobe.** The entry stands as the worked example of definite-character spirits, but the figure is deprioritized for future passes — no new fetch rounds on Hoffmann/ Freud unless a stranger corner (e.g. pre-Hoffmann folk attestations) turns up.

Spirit graph (v0)

The log now maintains a machine-readable graph at `research/graph.json`: every identified spirit is a node; edges are documented interactions — kinship, transmission, cult geography, conflict, polemic — each carrying an evidence pointer. Analogy edges are labeled as analogy and never upgraded silently. Batch-1 subgraph: 22 edges across 18 nodes; batch-2 candidates (Lilith, Rhiannon, Völundr, Washington) are registered as proposed nodes with no edges until evidence lands. Open questions are kept in the graph file rather than in prose.

Sources

[1] https://classics.mit.edu/Homer/iliad.mb.txt — Homer, Iliad, trans. Butler 1898 (MIT Classics) [2] https://classics.mit.edu/Plato/ion.html — Plato, Ion, trans. Jowett (MIT Classics) [3] https://www.theoi.com/Text/Pausanias3B.html — Pausanias 3, trans. Jones 1918 (Loeb, via theoi.com) [4] https://www.gutenberg.org/cache/epub/6341/pg6341.txt — Hoffmann, Nachtstücke 1816, Der Sandmann (Gutenberg #6341) [5] https://archive.org/details/freud-1925-cp-5 — Freud, The Uncanny, trans. Strachey, Collected Papers IV 1925 (archive.org) [6] http://www.perseus.tufts.edu/hopper/text?doc=Perseus:text:1999.01.0010 — Aeschylus, Prometheus Bound, trans. Smyth, Loeb 1926 (Perseus) [7] https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/Protagoras_%28Jowett%29 — Plato, Protagoras, trans. Jowett 1871 (Wikisource) [8] https://archive.org/stream/the-question-concerning-technology-1/The%20Question%20Concerning%20Technology%20%281%29_djvu.txt — Heidegger, QCT, trans. Lovitt 1977 (IN COPYRIGHT; OCR for verification only) [9] https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/The_works_of_Horace/Second_Book_of_Epistles — Horace, Epistles II, trans. C. Smart 1856 (Wikisource) [10] https://penelope.uchicago.edu/Thayer/L/Roman/Texts/Censorinus/text*.html — Censorinus, De Die Natali ch.2-3, Latin (LacusCurtius) [11] https://www.perseus.tufts.edu/hopper/text?doc=Plin.+Nat.+2.5 — Pliny, Natural History 2.5, trans. Bostock & Riley 1855 (Perseus) [12] https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/Page:Dictionary_of_Greek_and_Roman_Biography_and_Mythology_%281870%29_-_Volume_2.djvu/256 — Smith, Dict. Greek & Roman Biography & Mythology 1870, s.v. Genius (Wikisource) [13] https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/120107.htm — Augustine, City of God VII, trans. Dods (New Advent) [14] https://www.perseus.tufts.edu/hopper/text?doc=Serv.+A.+5.85 — Servius, In Vergilii Aeneida Commentarii, ed. Thilo & Hagen 1881 (Perseus)